Christy Yu

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Education

Carnegie Mellon University 3.9 GPA | Aug. 2025 – Aug. 2026
Masters in Human Computer Interaction, School of Computer Science *Pittsburgh, PA*

UC Santa Barbara 3.75 GPA | Aug. 2021 – Jun. 2025
B.S. Computer Science, Statistical Science Minor *Santa Barbara, CA*

Experience

Designer & Engineer Lead Jan. 2026 - Jul. 2026
Collier Township (Capstone) *Pittsburgh, PA*

- **Raised policy comprehension by 44%** among low tech-literacy residents of a **9k-resident** township, covering decisions, legal constraints, and budgets
- Built AI aid to retrieve and analyze civic data, **cutting time by 50%** for drafting new policies and grant proposals
- Validated product through 155 user tests, 30 qualitative interviews, 39 survey responses, and 6 in-person field visits across 13 iterations and 4 stages of research and design

Product Design Intern Jan. 2026 - Present
PLUS – Tutoring platform of 3k+ students, 500+ tutors *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Designed 4 end-to-end features, published design system components and dev hand-off documentation
- Collaborated with design lead, PM, and lead tutors to define product direction, specs, and edge cases for improving student-tutor matching algorithm quality
- Delivered 3 flows for student-tutor matching to incorporate language compatability, reduce manual fixes from supervisors, and support instant explicit overrides through database

UI/UX Design Intern Jun. 2025 - Aug. 2025
Dawdle AI – Anti-procrastination app startup, featured in KCBS radio *San Francisco, CA*

- Designed UI and flows with 30+ screens shipped to App Store launch with **200+ users at 5-star rating**
- Collaborated with CEO and cross-functional engineering team to strategize AI coaching features from beta feedback
- Built 40+ component design system in **Figma** reducing design-to-dev iteration cycles by **25%**

Founding Designer & Frontend Engineer Oct. 2024 – Aug. 2025
JAFFX — open-source guitar pedal startup *Santa Barbara, CA*

- Secured **$7,500** funding, **2nd in 44 teams** at UCSB New Ventures Competition, pitch deck co-wrote with CEO
- Established full brand identity and design system from scratch (logo, typography, color)
- Developed responsive main website **(Next.js & React)** (live at jaffx.audio)

Software Engineer Intern Jun. 2024 – Aug. 2024
Lorentz Solution *Santa Clara, CA*

- Automated library clean-up and migrated **44 dynamic libraries** from **RHEL6** to **RHEL8** via **Bash** scripting, cutting backup and release package storage by **10%**

Data Analyst Research Fellowship Jan. 2023 – Aug. 2025
Human Wildlife Conflict emLab *Santa Barbara, CA*

- Built **habitat suitability ML models** in **R** for a **3rd-authored PNAS Nexus** paper on how climate change drives human-elephant conflict in Namibia

Projects

Refract | Anti-deepfake ID Protection ML software Jan. 2024 - May. 2024

* Built AI model and frontend app **(Tailwind/Javascript/CSS, Figma)** that disrupts identity-theft deepfakes model training, research poster winning 2nd in annual showcase
* Cloaked images **disrupts deepfake models by 70%** with no visual difference to the human eye

Other projects on GitHub

Skills

Design: Visual UI, Prototyping, Usability Testing, Computer Vision, Data Science, UX Research, Product Strategy, Digital Products, HCI, Figma, Photoshop, Adobe, Claude Code,
Languages: Python, HTML/CSS/Javascript, TypeScript, R, SQL, C++, Java, Bash, MATLAB